Read Your Own Bible Carefully

Eight questions, all of them answerable from the Bible on your own shelf.

Every question below can be checked in your own New World Translation, and one of them in your own *Kingdom Interlinear*. Nothing here asks you to trust a website, a scholar or a church. The references are given in full so that you can look them up for yourself, and if any of them turns out to be wrong it will not take you long to find that out.

ONE

Revelation 22:12 records a promise: the speaker is coming quickly, and the reward he gives is with him. Four verses later, at 22:16, the same voice says, “I, Jesus, sent my angel.” Nothing between the two marks a change of speaker. Revelation 22:12, 16, New World Translation, 2013.

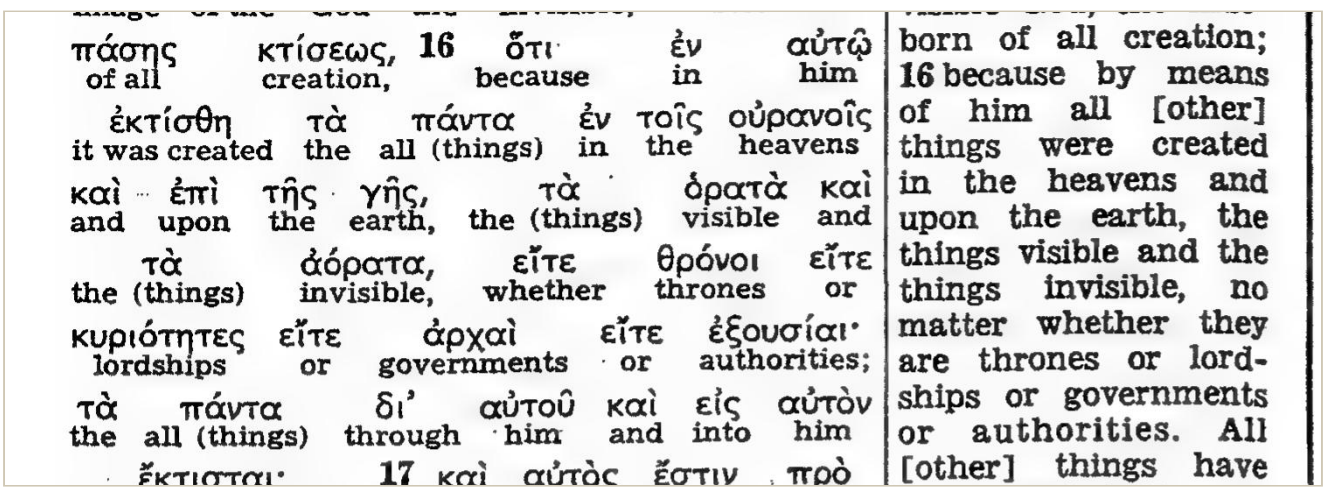
Who is coming quickly?

TWO

Isaiah 9:6 gives the child four titles, and one of them is Mighty God. Two chapters later, at Isaiah 10:21, a remnant returns to the Mighty God — and the footnote in your own Bible at 10:21 gives the Hebrew and refers you back to the footnote at 9:6. Isaiah 9:6; 10:21 and footnote, New World Translation, 2013.

Why does your own footnote link them?

THREE



πάσης of all	κτίσεως,	16	ὅτι because	ἐν in	αὐτῷ him	born of all creation; 16 because by means of him all [other] things were created in the heavens and upon the earth, the things visible and the things invisible, no matter whether they are thrones or lordships or governments or authorities. All [other] things have
ἐκτίσθη it was created	τὰ the	πάντα all (things)	ἐν in	τοῖς the	οὐρανοῖς heavens	
καὶ and	ἐπὶ upon	τῆς the	γῆς, earth,	τὰ the (things)	ὁρατὰ visible	καὶ and
τὰ the (things)	ἀόρατα, invisible,	εἴτε whether	θρόνοι thrones	εἴτε or		
κυριότητες lordships	εἴτε or	ἀρχαὶ governments	εἴτε or	ἐξουσίαι· authorities;		
τὰ the	πάντα all (things)	δι’ through	αὐτοῦ him	καὶ and	εἰς into	αὐτὸν him
ἔκτισται·	17	καὶ	αὐτός	ἐστιν	πρὸ	

The Kingdom Interlinear Translation of the Greek Scriptures, Watch Tower Bible and Tract Society, 1969, p. 896, at Colossians 1:16. Reproduced for criticism and review.

The line under the Greek is the Society’s own word-for-word rendering. The column beside it is the New World Translation. One of them has the word “other” in it. The other has it nowhere.

Where did “other” come from?

FOUR

John 1:18 uses the same Greek word for God twice, and neither time does the definite article stand in front of it. Your Bible renders the first one “God” — no man has seen God at any time — and the second one “god,” lowercase. John 1:18, New World Translation, 2013.

Same verse, same form. Why the difference?

FIVE

2 Peter 1:1 speaks of our God and the Savior Jesus Christ. 2 Peter 3:18 speaks of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. In Greek the two phrases are built the same way, three chapters apart, in a letter three chapters long — and they are handled differently in English. 2 Peter 1:1; 3:18, New World Translation, 2013.

What decided which way each one went?

SIX

From 1950 to 1970 your translation said the angels were to worship the firstborn at Hebrews 1:6. The 1971 revision changed it to “do obeisance.” In the 1969 interlinear the line under the Greek already read “do obeisance” while the column beside it still read “worship.” Hebrews 1:6; Kingdom Interlinear, 1969, p. 965.

What changed between those printings?

SEVEN

At Isaiah 44:24 Jehovah says that he stretched out the heavens by himself and spread out the earth. Then he asks a question about it, and the question is his rather than ours: who was with me? Isaiah 44:24, New World Translation, 2013.

How would you answer it?

EIGHT

In Isaiah 6:8–10 Isaiah hears Jehovah speak and is sent with a message. In Acts 28:25 Paul quotes that same message and says the holy spirit spoke it through Isaiah. Isaiah 6:8–10; Acts 28:25, New World Translation, 2013.

Who was speaking to Isaiah?

If you checked any of those, you already know the useful thing: each one is in your own Bible, at the reference given, saying what this sheet said it says. That was the only purpose of the sheet. If a single reference here is wrong, it deserves to be said out loud and corrected.

These questions do have answers, and the answers are longer than a page. The next document works through them one at a time. It sets out what each passage says, checks what comes before and after it so that nothing is being read out of context, gives the Watchtower’s own published response to each one and answers it, and ends with a list of the arguments we decided not to use and why they were dropped. It is a study rather than a leaflet, and it will take an evening rather than a minute.

The longer document:

ankyra.uk/docs/JW-2-The-Divine-Identity-of-Christ.pdf

It goes to a PDF, nowhere else, and nothing is asked of you when you arrive.